

Yoruba Syllabus

Unified Tertiary Matriculation Examination (UTME) 2026 — JAMB

GENERAL OBJECTIVES

The aim of the Unified Tertiary Matriculation Examination (UTME) 2026 syllabus in Yorùbá is to prepare the candidates for the Board's examination. It is designed to test their achievement of the course objectives, which are to:

- stimulate and sustain their interest in Yorùbá language, literature and culture;
- acquire basic knowledge and skill in Yorùbá language, literature and material and non-material aspects of culture.

STRUCTURE OF THE EXAMINATION

The test will be of an objective type, candidates will answer forty (40) multiple-choice questions covering all aspects of the syllabus:

1. LANGUAGE:

- (a) Comprehension (1 prose and 1 verse) — 08 items
- (b) Essay writing — 01 item
- (c) Sound system — 04 items
- (d) Grammar — 05 items
- (e) Current orthography — 02 items
- (f) Translation — 01 item

2. LITERATURE:

- (a) Oral — 04 items
- (b) Written — 06 items

3. CULTURE — 09 items

TOTAL — 40 items

1. LANGUAGE

(a) Comprehension

- (i) Prose
- (ii) Verse

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- identify central issues in a passage and draw appropriate conclusions;
- determine basic assumptions and express ideas; and
- identify the meanings and functions of given phrases and sentences.

(b) Essay Writing

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

identify different types of essay; and
apply different types of techniques associated with each type.

(c) Sound System

Topics

- (i) Production of sounds (consonants and vowels);
- (ii) Tones and tone change;
- (iii) Syllable structure;
- (iv) Sound processes: co-vowel occurrence, elision and deletion, etc.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- identify organs of speech, speech sounds and parameters for describing each speech sound;
- (ii) a. determine their correct usages;
- (ii) b. identify linguistic errors (pronunciations and wrong usages);
- determine the syllable components of words;
- demonstrate knowledge of the basic principles underlying the relationship between sounds.

(d) Grammar

Topics

- (i) Morphology — Word-formation;
- (ii) Loan-word integration;
- (iii) Word classes — nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, pronouns, conjunctions, prepositions, etc.
- (iv) Phrases and clauses — types and functions;
- (v) Sentences — types, structures and functions.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- demonstrate good knowledge of word derivation;
- demonstrate knowledge of word adoption;
- identify the appropriate class a word belongs to;
- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of Yorùbá syntax;
- identify the types, structures and functions of sentences.

(e) Current Orthography

Objectives

Candidates should be able to present ideas in acceptable written form.

(f) Translation

Objectives

Candidates should be able to interpret sentences and ideas in accordance with acceptable principles.

2. LITERATURE

(a) Oral Literature

(i) Prose

Babalola, A. (2005). *Àkójọpọ Àlọ Ijapa* (Apa Kinni). Ibadan: University Press PLC.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- identify central issues, problems and the component parts of an idea presented in a work;
- draw appropriate conclusions.

(ii) Poetry

Babalola, A. (2001). *Àwọn Oríkì Orílẹ̀ Mètàdínlógbon*, pp. i-x & 117-314. Lagos: Longman Nigeria PLC.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- deduce logical inferences from abstract relations of components of an idea in a work;
- identify the figurative and idiomatic expressions in the poem.

(b) Written Literature

(i) Prose

Awe, D. (2016). *Moremi Ajasoro*. Ilesa: Elyon Publishers.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- demonstrate good knowledge of ideas in works of art;
- draw moral lessons from the text;
- identify the narrative techniques in the text;
- identify the figurative and idiomatic expressions in the text.

(ii) Poetry

Akanji. *Aşọ Enu Akewi*. Ibadan: Genius Books Publishers.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- deduce the import of written works of art and genres;
- identify the figurative and idiomatic expressions in the poem.

(iii) Drama

Isola, A. (2014). *Nitori Owo Osogbo*. Sunmob Publishers.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- identify the central theme of works;
- interpret same in accordance with acceptable principles of the society;

identify types of drama;
identify the figurative and idiomatic expressions in the drama;
extract the narrative techniques in the drama.

Candidates should be able to:

deduce the import of written works of art and genres;
identify the figurative and idiomatic expressions in the poem.

Note: this second set of objectives repeats the Poetry objectives verbatim and appears exactly this way in the source syllabus.

3. CULTURE

1. Èrò àti ìgbàgbọ́

Topics

Olódùmarè, àkùdàáyà, emèrè, àjẹ, àwọn irúnmọlẹ̀ abbl.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to distinguish traditional practices and acceptable ways of life from modern and common sense beliefs.

2. Ètò ìsèlú àti ààbọ́ ilú

Topics

Ègbé àti ọgbà, oyè jíjẹ àti àwọn ìjòyẹ, ogun jíjà abbl.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to assess the functions and roles of individuals, chieftains, and groups in ensuring peace, stability and continuity of society.

3. Ètò ìsìnkú àti ogún pín-pín

Topics

Òkú àgbà, òkú ọfọ, òkú òòṣà, ìtúfò, ilẹ̀òkú gbígbe, ídí igi, mọlébí, bàbá ìsìnkú abbl.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

distinguish between traditional practices;
relate them to funerals and inheritance.

4. Ònkà Yorùbá

Topics

Oókan títídé ọkẹ kan (1–20,000).

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

count in Yorùbá numerals;
apply addition, deduction and division methods in Yorùbá.

5. Ayèyè

Topics

ìgbéyàwó, ìsọmọlórúkọ, ìwúyè abbl.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to relate social activities and events to appropriate situations.

6. Ètò ìwòsàn

Topics

ìtójú aláìsàn, ìtójú àtììgbẹbí aboyún, abbl.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge of the best way of using the appropriate health care practices.

7. Eré idárayá

- (i) eré òṣùpa-àlọ, bojúbojú abbl;
- (ii) eré ojúmọmọ-ìjàkadì, ayò, òkòtó, àrín abbl.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- identify types of Yorùbá traditional games;
- identify rules and regulations guiding each game;
- mention values derived from each game.

8. Ìṣẹ̀ àbíníbí àti ounjẹ ilẹ̀ Yorùbá

- (i) Ìṣẹ̀-àgbé ìṣonà, ìlù lílù abbl;
- (ii) Oúnjẹ-àbàrí, iyán, ẹwà abbl.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- demonstrate adequate knowledge of the various traditional professions;
- compare various traditional professions;
- demonstrate knowledge of preparing each type of Yorùbá food;
- mention nutritional values of each food.

9. Ẹkọ ilé

Topics

Ìwà ọmọlúàbí àti àǵfààní rẹ.

Objectives

Candidates should be able to identify acceptable patterns of behaviour and attitude that conform with societal norms and values.

RECOMMENDED TEXTS

LANGUAGE

- Abiódún, J. (1995). Àròkọ àti Aáyàn Ògbufò. Lagos: MAJAB Publishers.
- Adéwọlé, L. O. et al. (2000). Exam Focus – Yorùbá Language for WASSCE/SSCE. Ìbàdàn: UP Plc.
- Awóbùlúyì, O. (1978). Essentials of Yorùbá Grammar. Ìbàdàn: UP Plc.
- Awóbùlúyì, O. (ed.). (1990). Yorùbá Metalanguage (Èdè-Ìperí Yorùbá) Vol. II. Ìbàdàn: UP Plc.
- Awóbùlúyì, O. (2008). Èkọ̀ Ìṣẹ̀dá-Òrò Yorùbá. Akurẹ: Montem Paperback.
- Awóbùlúyì, O. (2013). Èkọ̀ Gírámà Èdè Yorùbá. Oṣogbo: Atman Ltd.
- Babalọlá, A. (ed.) (1991). Íwé Ìmọ̀dẹ̀tun Yorùbá SSI-SSIII. Ìbàdàn: Longman.
- Bámgbóṣé, A. (ed.) (1984). Yorùbá Metalanguage (Èdè-Ìperí Yorùbá) Vol. 1. Ìbàdàn: UP Plc.
- Bámgbóṣé, A. (1990). Fọ̀nọ́lọ́jì àti Gírámà Yorùbá. Ìbàdàn.
- Mustapha, O. (ed.). (1988). Èkọ̀-Èdè Yorùbá Òde-òní SSI-SSIII. Ìbàdàn: Macmillan Publishers.
- Mustapha, O. (ed.). (1991). Èkọ̀-Èdè Yorùbá Titun SSI-SSIII. Ìbàdàn: UP Plc.
- Ọ̀dẹ̀tókun, A. et al. (2005). Íwé Ìgbàràdì fún Ìdánwó Yorùbá. Ìbàdàn: Macmillan Publishers.
- Owólábí, K. (1989). Ìjìnlẹ̀ Ìtupalẹ̀ Èdè Yorùbá (1): Fónẹ́tíkì àti Fọ̀nọ́lọ́jì. Ìbàdàn: Oníbọ̀nọ̀jẹ Press.
- Owólábí, O. et al. (1999). Countdown WASSCE/SSCE, NECO, JME (Íwé Ìgbàràdì fún Ìdánwò Àṣekágbá Yorùbá). Ìbàdàn: Evans.
- Ọ̀yádẹ̀yí, O. (1998). Ìjìnlẹ̀ Fọ̀nọ́lọ́jì àti Gírámà Èdè Yorùbá. Ìbàdàn: Heinemann.

LITERATURE

All the prescribed texts are reflected as applicable on the syllabus under the Topics/Contents/Notes column.

CULTURE

- Adéọyè, C. L. (1979). Àṣà àti Iṣẹ Yorùbá. Ìbàdàn: OUP.
- Adéọyè, C. L. (1985). Ìgbàgbọ̀ àti Èṣìn Yorùbá. Ìbàdàn: Oníbọ̀nọ̀jẹ Press.
- Ládélé, T. A. A. et al. (1986). Àkọjọ̀pọ̀ Íwádíí Ìjìnlẹ̀ Àṣà Yorùbá. Ìbàdàn: Macmillan Publishers.

Note: The video recording provided ends partway through the Culture reference list; if the source document continues beyond this point, please share the remaining portion so it can be added.